Chapter 9

Deeper Waters

The year 1975 brought some grim forebodings for Indira Gandhi, then in her ninth successive year as the Indian Prime Minister. Her great victory in the December 1971 war with Pakistan and her engineering the creation of the new nations of Bangladesh and a smaller Pakistan had long been forgotten. Despite signing the Shimla Agreement in July 1972 and the consequent return of over 90,000 Pakistani prisoners of war, coupled with the dropping of all charges of committing war crimes by Pakistan Army officers, the Pakistani Prime Minister, Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, had gone back on his word to transform the newly named and demarcated LoC in Jammu and Kashmir into an international border. Within India, Jayaprakash Narayan's movement demanding a 'total revolution' had gathered an ominous momentum and Indira Gandhi was facing a huge amount of political opposition. The Allahabad High Court was close to deciding on the election petition filed against Indira Gandhi's election from Rae Bareli in UP, and in the US, President Nixon had been forced to resign following the Watergate scandal.